Event Information:

Description:

This alert was triggered when a user attempted to access an external URL that is listed in the organization's blacklist or threat intelligence feeds. The firewall or proxy successfully blocked the outbound request, preventing the connection. Note: The blacklist only covers known threats. It does not guarantee protection against new or unknown malicious domains.

datasource:

firewall

timestamp:

10/16/2026 10:59:27.685

Action:

blocked

SourceIP:

10.20.2.17

SourcePort:

34257

DestinationIP:

67.199.248.11

DestinationPort:

80

URL:

http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340

Application:

web-browsing

Protocol:

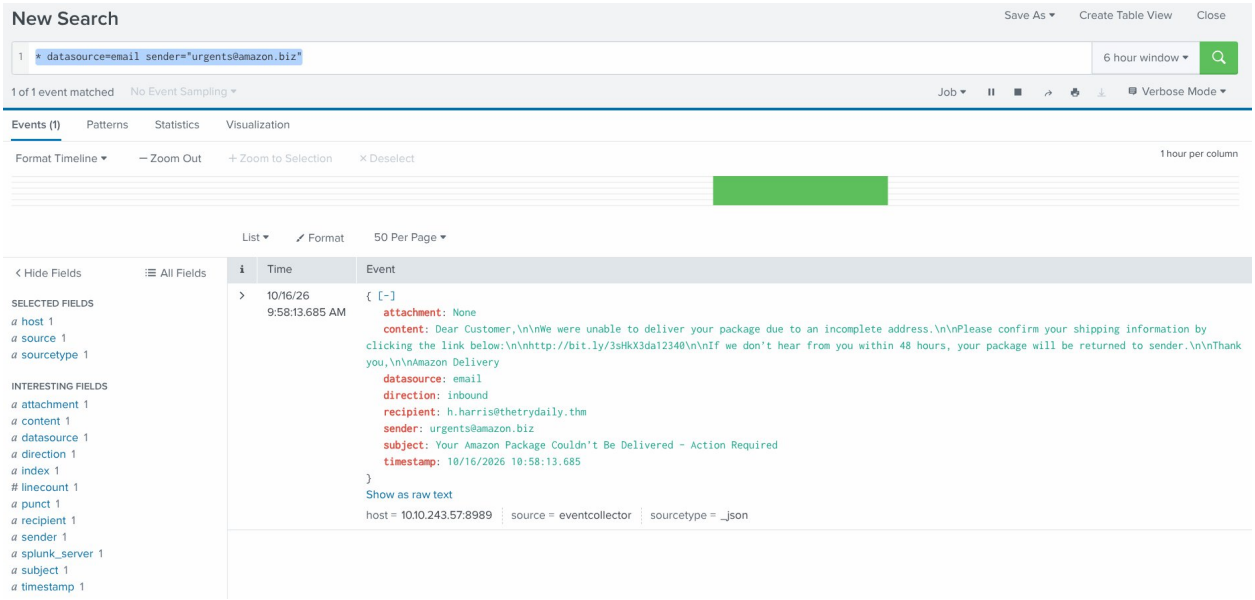
TCP

Rule:
Blocked Websites

Analysis Steps:

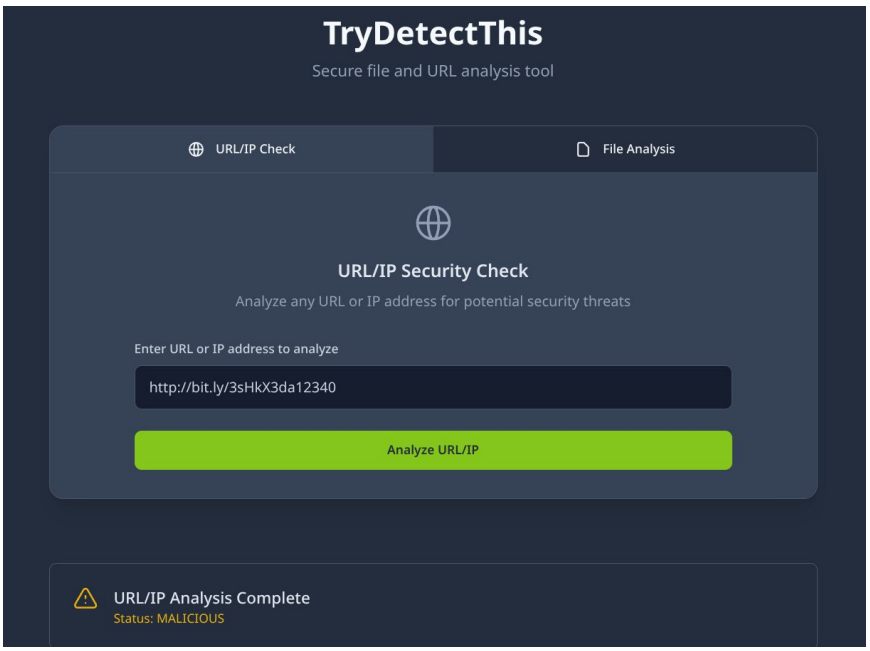
This alert was generated as a result of the malicious URL from the alert: “8815 Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link” being accessed. This was found to be a failed True Positive via the steps taken below.

The logs within Splunk were filtered by data source and sender to find the email which triggered the alert:
* datasource=email sender="urgents@amazon.biz"



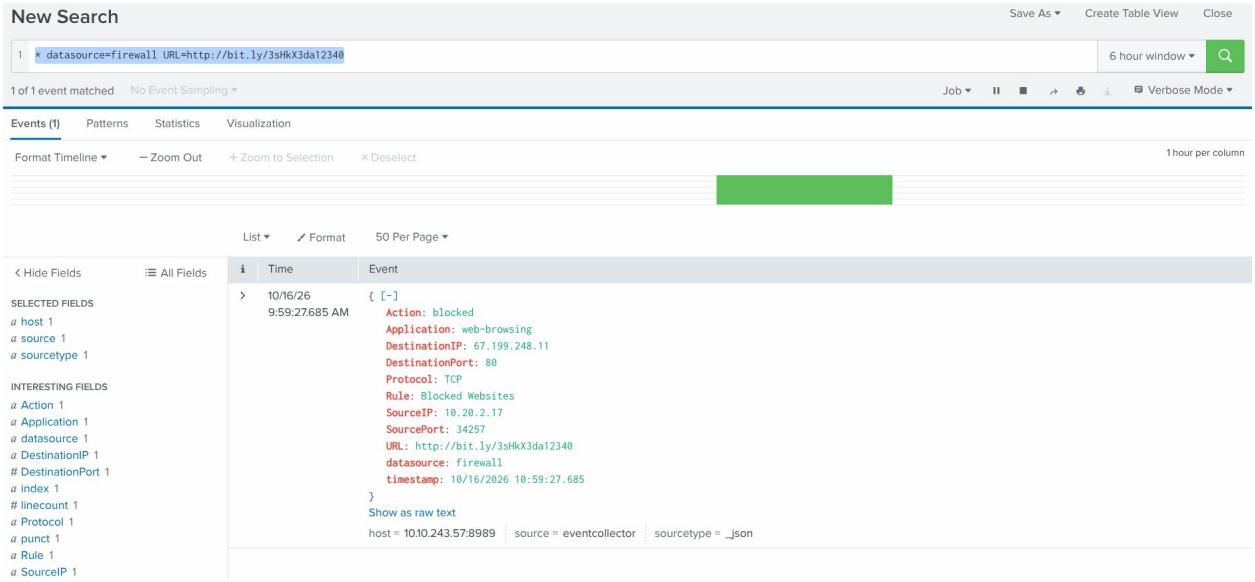
The sender of the email attempts to impersonate as Amazon. They include urgent wording which is a common tactic in phishing emails. They use a bitly shortened URL which is not in-line with legitimate business practice and a common obfuscation tactic.

To evidence this being the case the URL was checked against internal threat intelligence and was found to be malicious.



Therefore, it was deemed necessary to search Firewall logs. It was found that the Firewall successfully blocked the user's attempt to access the malicious URL.

* datasource=firewall URL=http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340



This information was enough to close the alert as a failed True Positive.

Report:

Time of activity:

Oct 16th 2026 at 11:00

List of Affected Entities:

Malicious Email Recipient: h.harris@thetrydaily.thm (10.20.2.17) (No other recipients found when searching the logs)

Reason for Classifying as True Positive:

This alert was generated as a result of the malicious URL from the alert: “8815 Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link” being accessed. This was found to be a failed True Positive.

The sender of the email is using impersonation to look like a legitimate Amazon email but on closer inspection this is not official Amazon infrastructure nor is this type of email common practice for Amazon. The link within the email also uses bitly URL shortening which is a common obfuscation tactic and not common practice for legitimate businesses. The email asked the recipient to confirm their shipping information, meaning the attacker's goal was to harvest the personal or shipping details the user would enter on the linked page. When checking our internal threat intelligence the link was found to be associated with malicious activities. The Firewall was, however, able to prevent the malicious URL from being accessed.

Reason for Escalating the Alert:

As the Firewall successfully blocked access of the malicious URL there is no need for escalation.

Recommended Remediation Actions:

It is important that employees have a strong awareness of what phishing emails look like to help prevent the risk of an attacker achieving initial access via this method. It may be worth running simulated phishing training and ensuring employees are well informed on how to spot these types of email.

List of Attack Indicators:

Malicious Email Recipient: h.harris@thetrydaily.thm (10.20.2.17)

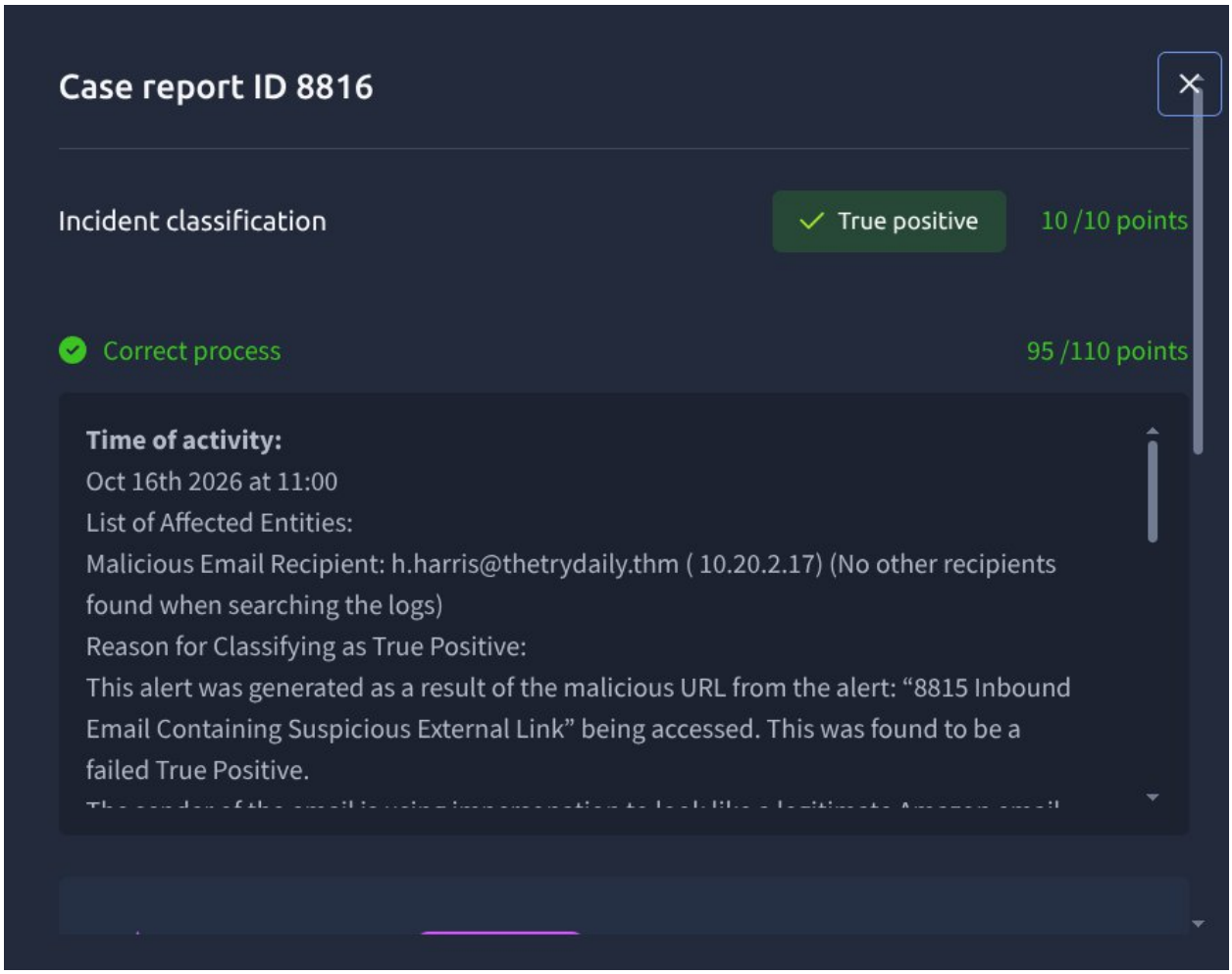
Sender: urgents@amazon.biz

Malicious URL: http://bit[.]ly/3sHkX3da12340 (67[.]199.248.11)

DestinationPort: 80

Protocol: TCP

Result:


Case report ID 8816
Incident classification
True positive
10 /10 points
Correct process
95 /110 points
Time of activity:
Oct 16th 2026 at 11:00
List of Affected Entities:
Malicious Email Recipient: h.harris@thetrydaily.thm (10.20.2.17) (No other recipients found when searching the logs)
Reason for Classifying as True Positive:
This alert was generated as a result of the malicious URL from the alert: “8815 Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link” being accessed. This was found to be a failed True Positive.